dominant trend in the Western Churches from the 1970s, were the French Louis Massignon, his Lebanese disciple, Youakim Moubarac, the Anglican canon Kenneth Cragg, and especially the Palestinian Arab Christian ideologue Naim Ateek.

FRANCE'S ARAB POLICY

France's Arab policy emerged in the 1960s under the presidency of Charles de Gaulle. After World War II, France was the first to give anti-Zionism its *lettre de noblesse* (patent of nobility). From the mid-1960s, General de Gaulle adopted a policy of rapprochement with the Soviet Union, the Non-aligned Nations, and especially the Muslim world.

To compensate for the loss of numerous French colonies in North and West Africa, and aware of America's ambitions in the Mediterranean, de Gaulle conceived several projects including the creation of a third bloc comprising the unification of states around the Mediterranean.[3] This Euro-Africa bloc would also unite the EC with the Arab countries. Maurice Couve de Murville, a former Vichy civil servant who held several ambassadorial posts in Arab countries and ministerial posts in the French Foreign office, was credited by Jacques Frémeaux with having built the entire Franco-Arab policy. The project for a Euro-Arab union was not new. On 25 October 1941 Hitler had already told the Italian minister, Count Ciano, that in the battle against America he envisaged "the common interests of a unified Europe within an economic zone completed by the African colonies."[4] The Vichy government doubtless knew about this project.

After the 1967 war, De Gaulle gave a notoriously anti-Israel press conference (27 November 1967) at which he announced that cooperation with the Arab world would become the basis of French foreign policy. Anxious to maintain French interests in the former French Arab colonies, he asked his former Minister of Information, Louis Terrenoire, to build a Franco-Arab network of solidarity.[5] Hence in 1967 the French Foreign Office created and funded the Association de solidarité franco-arabe (ASFA)**.** Its president, Lucien Bitterlin, edited its monthly review *France-Pays Arabes* at the left-wing Catholic anti-Israel bastion, *Témoignage Chrétien*; its director Georges Montaron (1921–1997) was also vice-president of ASFA and an intransigent enemy of Israel. Supported by the French ruling class, writes Frémeaux, "this association is the most active organ of the Palestinian cause."[6]

The first trans-European and coordinated expression of the Eurabian ideology appeared officially at the Cairo Symposium (25–26 January 1969)

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